

Our Journey

Empowering Growth
and Expanding Reach

1979	1981	1982	1991	1992	1993
Savola is established, with a paid-up capital of 40 million and 50 employees.	Savola's edible oil refinery in Jeddah, the first in Kingdom of Saudi Arabia, begins operations.	Launch of Afia premium corn oil. By the late 1980s, Savola captures 70% of the Saudi edible oil market.	Acquisition of a 40% stake in Almarai.	Savola becomes a publicly listed company on the Saudi Stock Exchange (Tadawul). Savola Bahrain and Savola Egypt commence edible oil operations.	Joint venture with Tate & Lyle to establish United Sugar Company, Saudi Arabia's first sugar refinery.
2006	2005	2004	2003	1998	1995
Savola invests in King Abdullah Economic City (KAEC) and Knowledge Economic City as a founding shareholder.	Savola establishes Kinan Real Estate, subsequently divesting 70% through private placement.	Panda launches the Hyper Panda format.	Savola Foods Company establishes edible oil businesses in Morocco and Sudan.	Savola enters the retail sector, following its merger with Azizia Panda. Savola gains a 70% stake in Herfy through the Panda merger.	Afia International Egypt is formed through the merger of Savola Egypt and SIME Derby Egypt. Savola Foods Company establishes an edible oil factory in Egypt.
2008	2009	2010	2011	2013	2015
Panda acquires Giant Stores and opens its first central distribution center in Riyadh.	Panda acquires Géant Stores operations and expands its network to 152 locations.	Savola launches its first CSR program, Makeen, to train and empower people with disabilities. Herfy is listed on the Saudi Stock Exchange (Tadawul) with Savola retaining 49% of its shares.	Standard & Poor's, Hawkamah and the International Finance Corporation rank Savola 2nd among top listed companies in the Arab world for governance and transparency. Savola Foods Company enters the pasta market by acquiring El Maleka Company and El Farasha Company in Egypt.	Savola's first Sukuk issuance (1.5 billion). Savola acquires Al Muhaidib's shares in Panda (18.6%) and Savola Foods Company (10%) in exchange for the issue of 33.9 million new Savola shares through a capital increase to 5.34 billion.	Savola Foods Company enters the seafood business with global seafood leader, Thai Union, to launch the famous John West brand in 12 markets across the MENA region. Savola Foods Company launches Afia Distribution Company in Saudi Arabia.



Our Journey (continued)

2016

Savola unveils a new brand identity, symbolizing its evolution to a strategic investment holding company. Savola receives the Sa’afa Award from the Integrity and Transparency Foundation.

2017

Savola sells a 2% stake in Almarai, as part of its capital re-allocation, while remaining the largest shareholder with a 34.52% stake.

Savola ranks top 10 for transparency in corporate governance, environment and social practices in MENA by S&P and Dow Jones indices and Hawkamah.

Savola launches its 2nd CSR program, Negaderha.

Savola Foods Company commissions a new factory in Jeddah to manufacture specialty fats for the B2B market.

Savola Foods Company establishes a joint venture in Iraq with Aves to create Bonus Food Company L.L.C., which is engaged in refining and packaging edible oils and vegetable ghee.

2018

Savola acquires a majority stake (51%) in Al Kabeer, one of the region’s leading frozen foods companies.

2019

Savola issues the 2nd tranche of Sukuk, pursuant to a new program in an aggregate amount of ﷲ 1 billion.

Savola is among the 31 companies added to MSCI (Morgan Stanley Capital International), as part of Tadawul’s inclusion into the MSCI Emerging Markets Index.

Standard & Poor’s, Hawkamah and the International Finance Corporation rank Savola 4th among top listed companies in the Arab world for governance and transparency.

2020

Savola named among Top 20 Great Places To Work® in the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia.

Savola ranked top 10 among all non-financial sector companies traded on Tadawul in the Corporate Governance Index (CGI) by Al Faisal University’s Corporate Governance Center.

Savola was among the Top 100 companies in the Middle East for 2020, according to Forbes Middle East, ranked 14th in the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia and 39th in the Middle East.

2024

Savola distributed its entire 34.52% stake in Almarai to its eligible shareholders, and to enable Savola to execute this transaction the Group issued a ﷲ 6 billion rights issue to strengthen its financial position followed by a capital reduction to ﷲ 3 billion.

Savola Group fully redeemed the ﷲ 1 billion Sukuk issued in 2019, enhancing its financial flexibility and supporting the Group’s future growth initiatives.

Savola Foods Company exits business in Iran for ﷲ 705 million, aligning with its prudent strategy to exit non-core markets and focus growth-oriented investments in its food platform.

2023

Savola Foods Company exited its operations in Morocco and Iraq.

Savola Foods Company launched Bayara World stores, which are Bayara’s retail stores in the United Arab Emirates, and strengthened the range of nuts, spices and legumes in the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia under Afia.

Al Kabeer rebranded its identity with a new distinguished appealing look and feel.

Savola acquired the minority stake in Panda Retail Company to become 100% owned by Savola.

2022

Savola agrees to sell its shares in Knowledge Economic City and Knowledge Economic City Developers Company Limited to Taiba Investment Company for ﷲ 459 million.

2021

Savola joined The Valuable 500 global initiative in 2021, which aims to enhance the inclusion of people with disabilities through the business sector, as a major driver of social change.

Savola Foods Company acquired 100% of Bayara for USD 260 million, in line with its ABCD growth strategy focused on expansion into high growth, value-added food categories with propositions directed toward the younger population.

